Lab 2 - Report

Citizens Face Delays in Government Service Approvals

1.Context

Human-Centric: Focus on citizens' daily struggles while accessing government services.

Identify: Long delays, unclear processes, repeated office visits.

Empathetic Design: Create systems that reduce stress and save time.

Reduce Burden: Minimize income loss and repeated travel.

Clear Communication: Provide transparent status updates.

Build Trust: Improve citizen confidence in public services.

Step 1: Target User Definition

Age: 25–60 years

Education: Primary to Degree level

Location: Rural and Semi-urban areas

Occupation: Daily wage workers, small business owners, homemakers

Service Used: Government schemes, certificates, approvals

Step 2: Initial Assumptions

ID	Assumption
A1	Citizens experience long delays in approvals.
A2	Citizens are not informed about application status clearly.
A3	Repeated office visits cause income loss.
A4	Complex procedures increase confusion and stress.

Step 3: Interview Questions

1. How long did your application take for approval?
2. Did you receive clear updates about your application?
3. How many times did you visit the office?
4. What problems did you face during the process?
5. What changes would make the process easier for you?

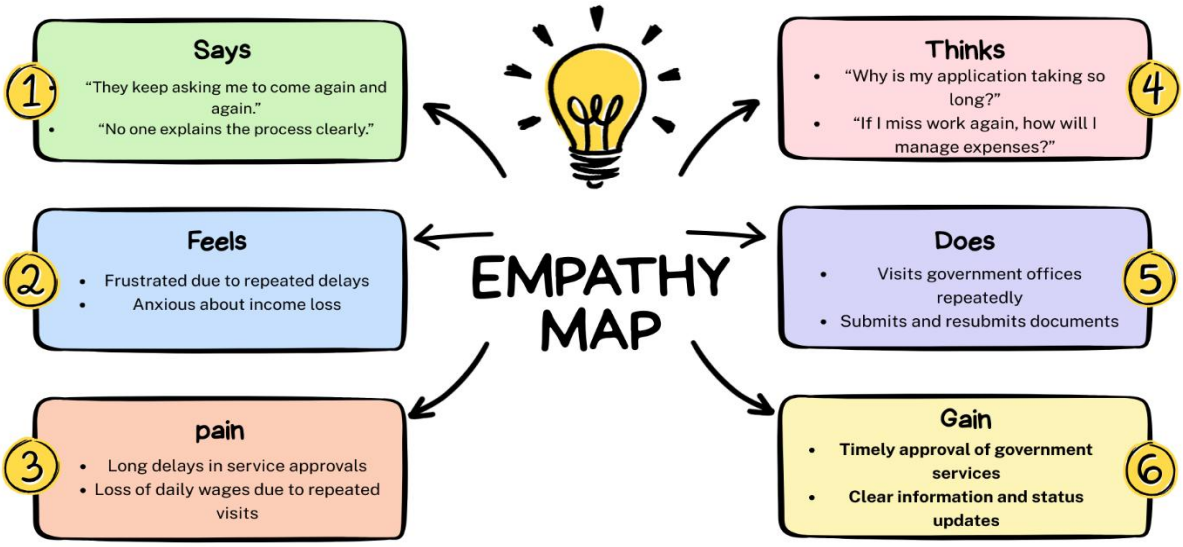
Step 4: User Interview Observations

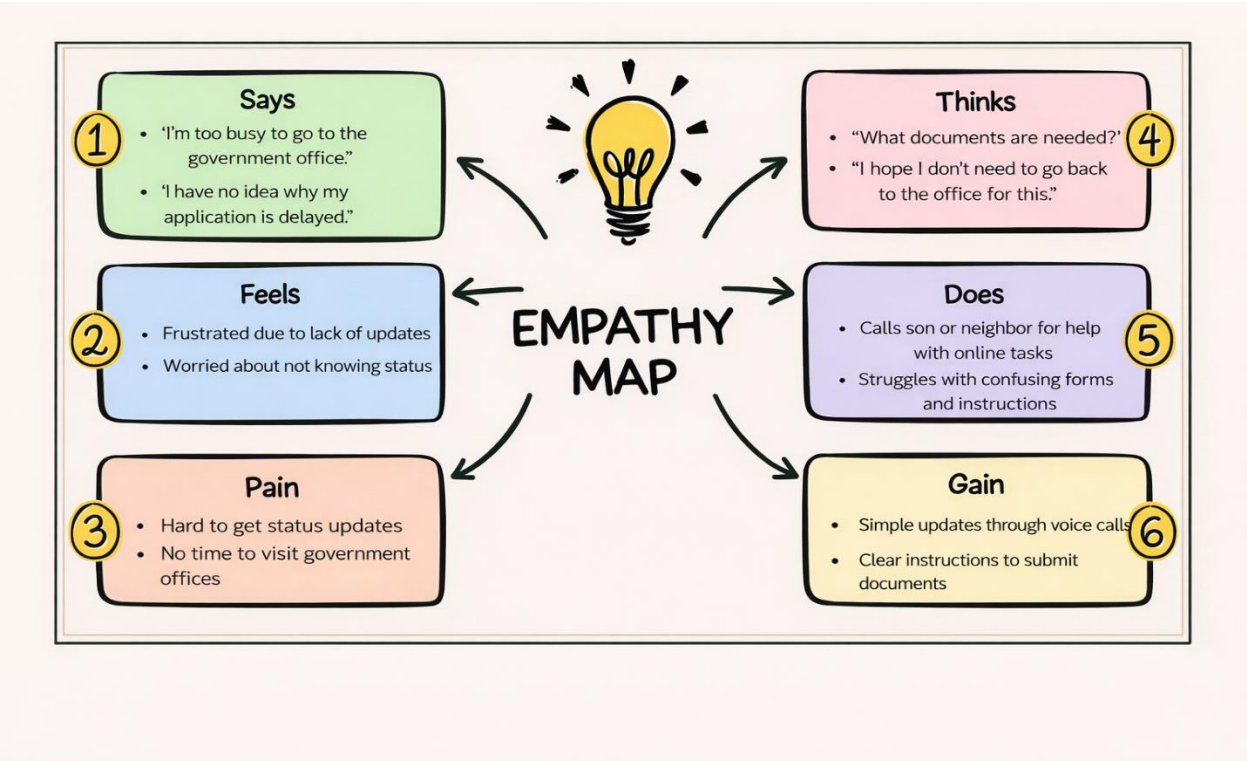
Observation: User appeared tired and frustrated while explaining delays.

Facial Expression: Worried and stressed when talking about income loss.

Exact Statement:
“I have visited the office four times, but my work is still not done.

Step 5: Empathy Maps


EMPATHY MAP
1
Says
"They keep asking me to come again and again."
"No one explains the process clearly."
2
Feels
Frustrated due to repeated delays
Anxious about income loss
3
pain
Long delays in service approvals
Loss of daily wages due to repeated visits
4
Thinks
"Why is my application taking so long?"
"If I miss work again, how will I manage expenses?"
5
Does
Visits government offices repeatedly
Submits and resubmits documents
6
Gain
Timely approval of government services
Clear information and status updates


EMPATHY MAP
1
Says
'I'm too busy to go to the government office."
'I have no idea why my application is delayed."
2
Feels
Frustrated due to lack of updates
Worried about not knowing status
3
Pain
Hard to get status updates
No time to visit government offices
4
Thinks
"What documents are needed?'
"I hope I don't need to go back to the office for this."
5
Does
Calls son or neighbor for help with online tasks
Struggles with confusing forms and instructions
6
Gain
Simple updates through voice calls
Clear instructions to submit documents

Step 6: Assumption Validation

A1: Citizens experience long delays.
Validation: True. Most users reported waiting weeks or months.

A2: Citizens are not informed clearly.
Validation: True. Many users said they did not receive proper updates.

A3: Repeated visits cause income loss.
Validation: True. Daily wage workers lose earnings when visiting offices.

A4: Complex procedures increase stress.
Validation: True. Users mentioned confusing forms and unclear requirements.

Step 7: User Insights

- Time and income are highly valuable for citizens.
- Lack of transparency increases frustration.
- Clear communication builds trust.
- Simple digital tracking can reduce physical visits.

Step 8 : User Persona

User Persona

> Every visit to the office costs me a day's wage, but my application is still not approved

Core Profile

Name: Ravi Kumar

Age : 38

Job: Daily wage worker

Education:Secondary School

Location:Murdeshwara

Background

Lifestyle:

Ravi Kumar starts his day early and works long hours as a daily wage worker to support his family. His income is irregular, so missing a workday to visit government offices affects his earnings. He uses a basic smartphone mainly for calls and messages and depends on others for online services. Evenings are spent with family, often discussing pending government approvals that impact household stability.

Pain Points:

- Long approval delays without clear reasons
- No proper status updates
- Complex procedures and paperwork

Audience Insights

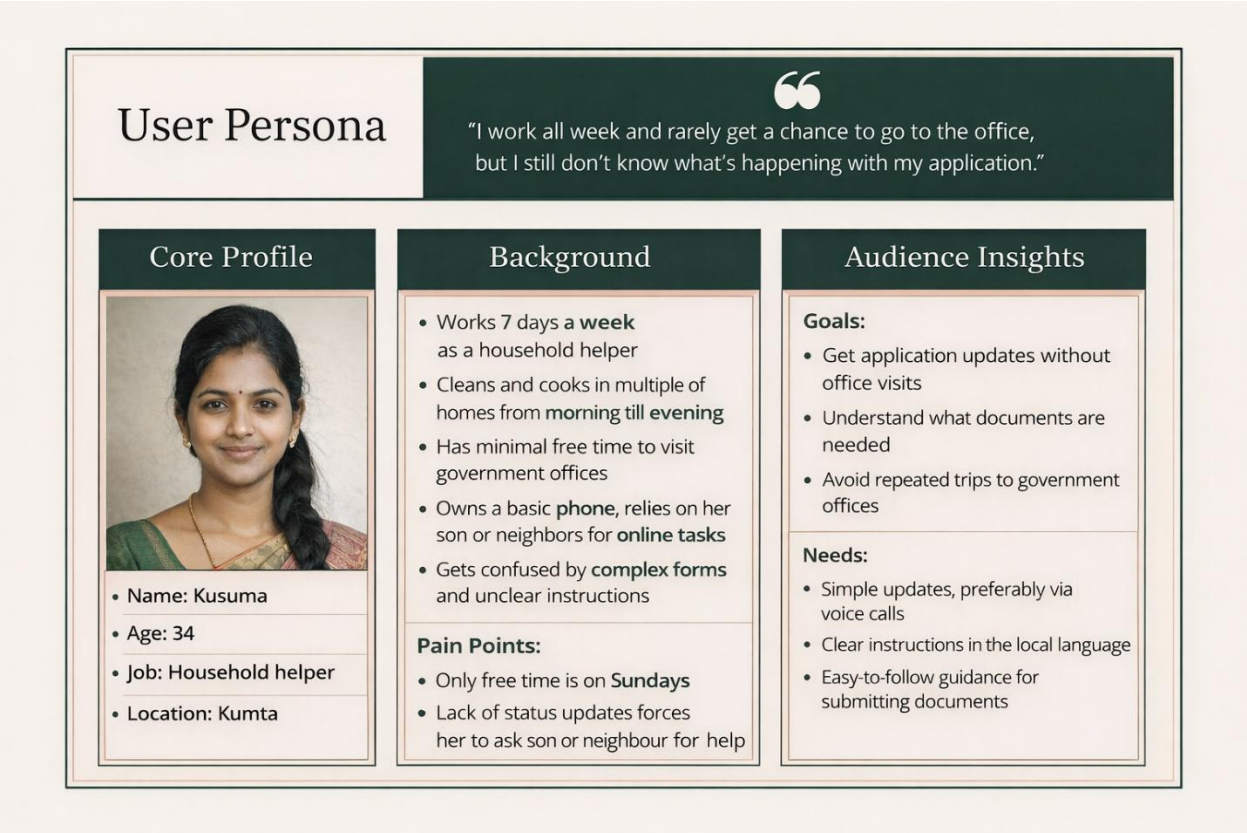
Goals:

- Get government services approved on time
- Avoid repeated office visits
- Clearly understand application status
- Save daily wages lost due to office visits

Needs:

- Transparent approval timelines
- Simple application process
- SMS or call-based status updates

User Persona -2



Step 9: Insights To Design Requirements

- Online application tracking system
- SMS/Call-based status updates
- Clear document checklist
- Time-bound approval process
- Helpdesk support in local language

Step 10: Reflection

1. What surprised you during the interview?
   It was surprising to see how much emotional stress citizens experience due to delays.
2. Which assumption was wrong?
   The assumption that citizens understand the process clearly was wrong. Many are confused about documentation requirements.
3. How did empathy change your thinking?
   It shifted focus from system efficiency to human experience and emotional impact.
4. How will this affect your design approach?
   Future designs will prioritize transparency, simplicity, and real user feedback.